Japan Trip Pre-Info Session FAQ (RAG Knowledge Base)

This document is a comprehensive FAQ compiled prior to the Info Session for the Japan Trip. It has been formatted and optimized to ensure each Q&A item provides self-contained context for optimal RAG (Retrieval-Augmented Generation) performance.

1. Cost & Budgeting

Q: How much will the Japan Trip participation fee cost?

A: We are currently negotiating to keep the total price under $2,000 USD. We will confirm the exact amount by the official Info Session.

Q: How much should I budget for flights and additional personal expenses?

A: As of October 11 estimates, flight costs are approximately $1,000+ USD for 1-stop flights and $1,100+ USD for direct non-stop flights. For personal expenses, around $500 USD should cover basic meals and local transportation between Kyoto and Osaka.

2. Schedule, Attendance & Itinerary

Q: Is it possible to join late or leave early during the Japan Trip?

A: Yes, joining late or leaving early is allowed. However, please note that the participation fee remains the same regardless of how long you participate, so we highly recommend attending the full Trip.

Q: Can I skip the Trip itself and only attend a few selected events?

A: No, partial attendance is not permitted. To keep things fair for everyone, you will need to pay the full Trip fee even if you only attend a portion of the events.

Q: Will we visit specific tourist spots in Kyoto, Hiroshima, or Tokyo during the Trip?

A: The full itinerary will be shared at the Info Session. You will also have ample opportunities to explore on your own during optional tours and free time in Kyoto and Tokyo.

Q: What is the schedule for March 21 (Trip Start Day)?

A: There are no scheduled official events on March 21. You only need to arrive in Japan, travel to Kyoto, and check into the hotel. The remainder of the day is yours for free time.

Q: Can I join the Trip on the morning of March 22 instead of March 21?

A: Our chartered bus leaves the hotel at 9:30 AM on March 22. Therefore, we strongly recommend arriving in Kyoto and checking into the hotel on the previous day (March 21).

Q: What is the schedule for March 27 (Trip End Day)?

A: There are no official activities scheduled on March 27. You will only need to check out of the hotel, so you may depart whenever works best for your travel schedule.

3. Flights, Transportation & Academics

Q: When do core final exams end, and when does the spring quarter start for FTMBA?

A: Core final exams run through Thursday, March 18, and spring quarter instruction begins on Monday, March 29.

Q: Are there any recommended flight dates or arrival/departure times?

A: Since finals run through Thursday, March 18, we recommend departing LAX on March 18 or 19 and arriving in Kyoto on Saturday, March 20. For the return trip, you can fly out of Japan starting Saturday, March 27. Depending on your class schedule, you may be able to stay longer. Be cautious with flights leaving LAX on the afternoon of March 19, as the time difference could cause you to arrive in Japan too late.

Q: What is the best way to travel from Los Angeles (LAX) to Kyoto?

A: Kansai International Airport (KIX) is the closest major international airport to Kyoto, with direct train or bus connections available. If you cannot find a suitable flight to KIX, you can fly into Tokyo (Haneda/HND or Narita/NRT) and take a domestic flight to Osaka Itami Airport (ITM), or travel from Shinagawa Station to Kyoto via the Shinkansen (Bullet Train). ZIPAIR, a low-cost airline owned by Japan Airlines, may be the cheapest option, though it only operates between LAX and Narita (NRT).

Q: Should I book my flight right now?

A: Your spot is only officially confirmed once applications open at the Info Session and you have paid the deposit. We recommend booking your flight after confirmation. If you are comfortable with the risk of ending up on the waitlist, you are welcome to book earlier.

4. Eligibility & Roommates

Q: Can students other than first-year full-time MBAs (FTMBA) join the Japan Trip?

A: Yes! The Trip is open to all current UCLA Anderson students, including second-year MBAs, FEMBA students, and students in other master's programs.

Q: Can I bring my significant other, and how many guests can I bring?

A: You can bring one Significant Other (SO). The participation fee for your SO will be the same as for Anderson students.

Q: Can I bring a friend who is not affiliated with Anderson, or an alumnus/alumna?

A: No, unfortunately not. The Japan Trip is not open to alumni or guests outside the Anderson community.

Q: Can I request a single room or a private shared room?

A: We are planning standard double rooms in Kyoto and Tokyo, and Japanese-style rooms shared by 4–5 people in Hiroshima. You may request a double or single room in Hiroshima, but availability is limited and an additional charge will apply.

Q: How are roommates assigned? Can I choose my roommate?

A: If your Significant Other is joining, you will automatically share a room with them. For other room assignments, we will survey your preferences and do our best to match you with your preferred roommates. Details will be finalized around February.

5. Meals & Dietary Restrictions

Q: Can you accommodate vegetarian diets, vegan preferences, and food allergies?

A: Yes, we expect to accommodate dietary needs for meals included in the Trip program, with options such as no meat, no seafood, or vegetarian meals. You can list your dietary requirements in your application.

Q: Will Halal meals be available during the Trip?

A: We can arrange options such as meals without meat, but we have not confirmed whether the meals are certified Halal. Please contact the organizing team directly if you require Halal meals.